



"By now, Dame Amici and my vassals have deposited your troll in the elevator. You may have your pooka back, as well, but my sister and I believe we shall keep the Eiluned for our trouble. *Do svidaniya.*"

Tisket and Gibraltar's simultaneous shouts *didn't* garner a response. The phone's screen was dark, the call ended. Tisket brought her foot down on it in frustration, stomping the phone over and over until the fine shards of glass looked like glitter on the cool marble floor.

"Tisk, get out of there," Gibraltar said. "Get to the elevator with Ranveig. I'll meet you in the lobby. We'll figure this out. Just move, Tisket. You've got to move."

"This is exactly what I wanted from my life!" Tisket said angrily. She wiped the tears from her eyes with the back of one hand, then transformed into an ermine, streaking through the felled bodies in the hallway to the elevator. She leapt up to smash the button with her front paws and then sprang inside the elevator as it opened, doing the same for the lobby button. Ranveig lay slumped against the elevator wall, bleeding and bruised. Tisket transformed back into her mortal seeming, pressing two fingers to Ranveig's neck to confirm she still had a pulse, all while Gibraltar continued his frantic instructions in Tisket's ear.

"What's your next great idea, Dolaidh?" Tisket demanded as the elevator quickly sank to the lobby. "I'm sure you have a brilliant plan to get Maarika out of this. You always have such brilliant plans."

"I'll figure it out, Tisket. I swear to you, I'll figure it out."

The elevator doors opened, Gibraltar already waiting to help Tisket drag Ranveig out of the elevator and towards the exit. Tisket looked at Gibraltar over Ranveig's drooping shoulders. She tightened her jaw and hoisted more of Ranveig's weight.

"I believe you, Dolaidh," Tisket said. "I have all the faith in you in the world."

